

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Hot, sticky air raises health risks

Heat wave's high humidity can pose danger to those without effective cooling

By **Adriana Pérez**
and **Lily Carey**
Chicago Tribune

Hot, steamy air blowing into Illinois from a heat dome moving east across the country has kicked off at least a week of dangerous heat, with humidity peaking Saturday

through Monday. These kinds of sticky temperatures with little to no overnight relief can pose a major to extreme risk to the health of anyone without access to effective cooling or adequate hydration. The National Weather Service has forecast daytime temperatures in the Chicago area will reach

highs in the low to mid-90s beginning Saturday and early into the week, while humidity will make several days in a row feel like at least 100 degrees. Nighttime temps will be in the low to upper 70s, but it might feel as hot as 90 degrees. "The temperatures themselves aren't even that impressive," said Trent Ford, the Illinois state climatologist. But that's dangerous, because people don't take this kind of heat as seriously as they should.

"Some folks may look at the high temperatures and say — 'Oh, it's only going to be in the 90s. It's not in the hundreds. That won't feel that bad,'" said Brett Borchardt, a senior meteorologist at the National Weather Service office in Chicago. "It's really the humidity where public health experts start to notice that there's more of an impact." Heat indices — a combination of atmospheric temperatures and relative humidity to deter-

mine how the heat really feels to the body — could be "potentially record-breaking" as they extend from Kansas City to Maine, Ford said. "The intensity of the humidity is going to be really, really something," he said. "It has the potential to have more health effects than other, in-your-face heat waves." On Sunday, wind gusts of over 30 miles an hour will combine

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Mayor Brandon Johnson chats with acting CTA President Nora Leerhsen and Chicago Chief Operating Officer John Roberson on a CTA Green Line train after attending the CTA All Stations Accessibility Program in Chicago's Austin neighborhood on March 31. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Records show mayor didn't conduct formal national search for CTA head

Johnson said last month his office had done so, something transit activists had pushed for

By **Talia Soglin**
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson's administration never undertook a formalized national search for a new CTA president despite the mayor saying last month that his office had in fact done so, according to responses to public records requests made by the Tribune. The CTA has been without a permanent leader since embat-

tled former President Dorval Carter stepped down earlier this year under pressure from lawmakers and transit activists who had long called for his removal. Last month, Johnson told local news site Block Club Chicago that his office had undertaken a national search for a new CTA head, something transit advocates had pushed for in the wake of Carter's resignation. "We were always in the process

of finding someone," Johnson told Block Club at the time. "It looked like any other national search." Johnson told Block Club the search had already been completed. But Freedom of Information Act requests filed by the Tribune failed to reveal records that demonstrated the city has undertaken a thorough or formalized search of any kind. The Tribune submitted Freedom of Information Act requests for records related to the search to three city departments: the mayor's office, the Law Depart-

ment and the Department of Procurement Services. All three departments told the Tribune they possessed no records of any contracts the city held with search firms involved in vetting candidates, nor invoices from such search firms, résumés of candidates who had been in the running for the job, or reports on the search process. In a statement, Cassio Mendoza, a spokesperson for the mayor, said the administration had "looked at" candidates

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Trump sets time for choice on Iran

President: Decision on US role to come within next 2 weeks

By **Sam Mednick, Natalie Melzer** and **Jon Gambrell**
Associated Press

BEERSHEBA, Israel — Israel and Iran exchanged more attacks on Thursday as President Donald Trump said he would make up his mind within two weeks on whether the U.S. military will get directly involved in the conflict, seeking to keep open the door to diplomacy on Tehran's nuclear program. "Based on the fact that there's a substantial chance of negotiations that may or may not take place with Iran in the near future, I will make my decision whether or not to go within the next two weeks," White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt told reporters, reading out Trump's statement. Trump has been weighing whether to attack Iran by striking its well-defended Fordo uranium enrichment facility, which is buried deep inside a mountain and

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INSIDE



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Crow-Armstrong's big season continues

He became the fastest player in franchise history to 20 home runs and 20 steals in a season, but Cubs fall 8-7 to Brewers. **Chicago Sports**

Is NASCAR moving race to San Diego?

After two years of rain-soaked events, NASCAR is reportedly in talks to hold a race in sunny San Diego. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

Play a reminder that war never goes away

The Poet in Court Theatre's "An Iliad" is like the Ghost of Wars Past, coming to warn those who fail to learn from past experience. **A+E**

City sees uptick in spaces dedicated to queer women

Advocates say many factors fueling rise in parties, social clubs

By **Carolyn Stein**
Chicago Tribune

When Aderinsola Akeju saw an ad on social media for an all-female slumber party, the former boarding school student was excited for the opportunity to fulfill a wistful dream. But instead of snacks and late-night conversations, the party

felt more like a rave she could find anywhere, she said. Disappointed, the 22-year-old decided to throw her own slumber party with friends complete with drinks, games and karaoke. "I had never felt so euphoric and happy about hosting something," Akeju said. That night inspired a broader vision, but it was not until she received \$10,000 a grant from the Human Rights Campaign's "Queer to Stay" program last

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Aderinsola Akeju, founder of the social club Pink Sappho, attends Pink Sappho's Happy Hour at Artis Restaurant and Lounge in Chicago on Wednesday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **85** Low **74**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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